

THE SESSION · POST-CLOSE READ

Hike Signal, *Stocks* Pause

The S&P 500 slipped 0.23% as the Federal Reserve's September minutes showed most participants expect another rate increase by year-end and the 10-year Treasury yield rose to about 5.36% intraday before easing. Dividend Strategy -1.01% trailed DVY and SPY; Growth Portfolio -0.98% trailed IUSG.

S&P 500 ▼ 0.23% NASDAQ ▼ 0.24% DOW ▼ 0.66% VIX ▲ 0.47% BRENT ▲ \$101

DIVIDEND STRATEGY

▼ TRAILED DVY + SPY

-1.01%

1-DAY

FCI		-1.01%
DVY		-0.42%
SPY		-0.23%

YTD +17.15% vs DVY +11.20% · SPY +14.87%

GROWTH PORTFOLIO

▼ TRAILED IUSG

-0.98%

1-DAY

FCI		-0.98%
IUSG		-0.24%

YTD +24.71% vs IUSG +18.70%

THE SESSION

Stocks slipped on Wednesday as the Federal Reserve's September minutes reinforced the case for further tightening. The S&P 500 fell 0.23% to 7,801, retreating from Tuesday's close above 7,800, while the Nasdaq lost 0.24% to 27,534 and the Dow 0.66% to 51,180; the VIX edged up to 15.08. The minutes showed most participants judged another increase in the policy rate likely appropriate by year-end, without indicating timing, following the committee's unanimous 25-basis-point increase in September. The 10-year Treasury yield rose to about 5.36% intraday before easing to about 5.28%, against Tuesday's official 5.27%, and Brent held near \$101 a barrel as attacks near the Strait of Hormuz renewed supply concerns. The Federal Trade Commission and the Department of Agriculture opened a request for public comment on agricultural equipment mar-

kets, and equipment makers fell, with Caterpillar down 5.76%. Bitcoin slid below \$84,000 as leveraged positions were unwound, with IBIT down 2.64% and ETHA 4.58%.

The Dividend Strategy fell 1.01%, behind DVY's 0.42% by 0.59 point and SPY's 0.23% by 0.78 point, with four of twenty-five holdings higher. Caterpillar was the largest drag, falling 5.76% to \$813.72 and subtracting about 0.15 point as the agricultural-equipment inquiry weighed on the group. Qualcomm fell 2.19% and NatWest Group 2.35%, subtracting about 0.10 and 0.09 point, neither on a company-specific catalyst. Constellation Energy edged back 0.27% to \$299.59 after Tuesday's 12.25% gain, while SS&C Technologies rose 0.91% and ADP 0.63%.

*Higher-for-longer rates tend to test valuations before they test earnings power.
Businesses with contracted revenue and strong balance sheets can be underwritten
through that rotation. Think Like an Owner.*

The Growth Portfolio fell 0.98% while IUSG fell 0.24%, behind by 0.74 point, with three of twenty-five holdings higher. Vistra was the only material offset, rising 3.85% to \$166.68 and adding about 0.22 point, extending Tuesday's 10.77% advance. Agnico Eagle was the largest drag, falling 3.02% to \$180.41 and subtracting about 0.18 point on a day gold fell 1.41%. MARA fell 5.56% and Hut 8 3.17%, subtracting

about 0.14 and 0.08 point as bitcoin declined, and Robinhood fell 2.22%. On the year, the Dividend Strategy stands at +17.15% against DVY's +11.20%, a +5.95-point spread, with SPY at +14.87%; the Growth Portfolio stands at +24.71% against IUSG's +18.70%, a +6.01-point spread.

FCI HOLDINGS · NOTABLE MOVERS

WINNERS

VST +3.85%

GROWTH

Closed at \$166.68, extending Tuesday's 10.77% advance; the Growth Portfolio's largest contributor.

CNX +1.95%

GROWTH

Rose to \$33.89 without a company-specific catalyst.

DECLINERS

CAT -5.76%

DIVIDEND

Fell to \$813.72 as agricultural-equipment makers declined on the FTC and USDA request for comment.

MARA -5.56%

GROWTH

Fell to \$10.36 as bitcoin slid below \$84,000.

SSNC +0.91%

DIVIDEND

Rose to \$78.70 without a company-specific catalyst.

ADP +0.63%

DIVIDEND

Rose to \$264.00 without a company-specific catalyst.

NXPI -3.75%

GROWTH

Fell to \$235.22 without a company-specific catalyst.

HUT -3.17%

GROWTH

Fell to \$89.30 as bitcoin declined.

YEAR-TO-DATE STANDING

DIVIDEND STRATEGY

+17.15%

vs DVY +11.20% / SPY +14.87%

Spread vs DVY +5.95 pts

GROWTH PORTFOLIO

+24.71%

vs IUSG +18.70%

Spread vs IUSG +6.01 pts

SOURCES

1. Yahoo Finance, "Stock Market Today: Dow Falls, S&P 500 and Nasdaq Retreat From Records Amid Bond Market Jitters," Oct. 7, 2026.
2. CNBC, "Fed Officials See Another Hike Coming, but No Sign as to When, Minutes Show," Oct. 7, 2026.
3. Federal Trade Commission, "FTC and USDA Seek Public Comment on Agricultural Equipment Manufacturing and Distribution Market Practices," Oct. 7, 2026.
4. Stocktwits (via Yahoo Finance), "DE, CNH, CAT, AGCO Stocks Slump – FTC, USDA Inquiry Puts Farm Equipment Market Practices in Focus," Oct. 7, 2026.
5. CoinDesk, "Live Updates: Bitcoin Slides Under \$84,000 as \$550 Million in Bets Get Liquidated," Oct. 7, 2026.
6. U.S. Department of the Treasury, Daily Treasury Par Yield Curve Rates, Oct. 6, 2026.
7. Market data and economic calendar: Financial Modeling Prep. Strategy returns: Paradiem FCI portfolio records.